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Economic importance of the family Apocynaceae

S.No	Economic importance	Binomial	Useful part	Uses
1	**Food plant**	*Carissa carandas* (பெரும்களா) *Carissa spinarum* (சிறுகளா)	Fruits	Edible and used in pickles
2	**Medicinal plant**	*Rauvolfia serpentina* (Indian snake root / sarpagandha)	Shoot Dried roots	To treat hypertension and mental disorders Alkaloid (reserpine) obtained from the dried roots, of the plant can lower the blood pressure and used as sedative for patients suffering from *Schizophrenia.*
		Thevetia peruviana (lucky nut/ தங்கஅலரி)	Seeds	Used in rheumatism
		Vallaris solanacea	Latex	Useful in toothache and to treat inflated gums.
		Cerbera odollam	Latex	Used as an emetic and purgative.
		Alstonia scholaris	Bark	Used in malaria and dysentery.
		Strophanthus hispidus	Seeds	Yield the drug strophanthin
		Wrightia tomentosa (பாலை)	Bark and Roots	Used as antidote to snakebite.
		Catharanthus roseus	Aerial parts	Used to treat muscle pain, the alkaloids like vinblastine and vincristine are mainly used to treat various human cancers.
		Caralluma umbellate (களிமுளியான்)	Succulent stem	Antiobesity